From: Selena Kelaher
To: Ramirez, Emilio
Subject: RE: Muslim Mortuary and Cemetery
Date: Tuesday, May 13, 2025 9:57:27 AM
Attachments: image001.png
MMCC_Env Justice Planning Project Evaluation 4-17-2025.docx

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Hi Emilio,

Thank you so much for the update. I am available anytime to discuss. Definitely free at 2:30 today and anytime tomorrow. We have to make one additional edit to the MND cultural mitigation measure based on the tribe's recent feedback and direction from the County Archaeologist. We expect to make the change today for County Counsel's review of the entire MND and hope that County Counsel's review is completed as soon as possible.

We did touch on community benefits in our meeting, specifically the Environmental Justice policies. Attached is the document evaluating the cemetery project and EJ policies. We are no longer proposing a bus shelter, but the non-profit does propose to provide enhanced landscaping, new fuel modification zones, trail connectivity, upgraded water line and lateral connection.

> The Muslim Mortuary and Cemetery Committee (MMCC) is an independent non-profit organization, licensed by the State of California Cemetery and Funeral Bureau, providing Islamic burial services to over 5,000 families through established cemeteries in Anaheim, Westminster, LaVerne, and Colton since 1991. The MMCC office is located in Garden Grove and staffed with a dedicated Funeral Director. Its operations rely on highly trained staff and volunteers to provide funeral services in accordance with the Islamic practices. Each of the existing cemeteries are smaller, with between 100 and 1,250 burial plots. The existing cemeteries cannot be expanded, and a new cemetery, more centrally located in Southern California that can provide a long-term solution for burial and funeral services, is needed. The MMCC proposes this Project to provide a long-term solution for burial services for the Muslim community of Southern California and the local Riverside County community.

Summary of Environmental Justice

- 84.99 acres of owned land and 45% of the land will be undeveloped, 38.6 acres. Approximately, 12.67 acres will be landscaped areas, basins, or landscaped slopes. And 24.6 acres are grave sites. This is near 90% of passive land use.

The site entry along Garfield will include enhanced landscaping:

- (19) nineteen – 18' brown trunk height date palm trees
- (2) two - 36" box flowering Accent Trees (Palo Verde or Chitalpa)
- 1-5 gallon shrubs and ground cover
- Guard Shack
- Decorative Fencing

- The project will include new Fuel Modification Zones for fire protection. Trees planned for the entry include fruitless olive and date palm, while the interior roads and pathways would be lined with accent trees such as Palo Verde and Marina Strawberry, and shade trees such as Jacaranda, Australian willow, evergreen Chinese Elm and Coast Live Oak.
- There will be approximately 1,780 linear feet of trails on-site and internal trail systems (walking paths) for cemetery use are also provided. Chain link fencing along the east perimeter will follow the limits of grading and landscape improvements to allow for the existing regional trail network to cross onto the property, outside of the fence line, and continue off-site to regional trails. There are controlled by gates on the private property along the east property line that connect to the regional trail if patrons want to walk along the internal regional trail or to the offsite regional trail.
- Approximately 3,062 linear feet of a new water line will be installed from 270 feet south of Senola Avenue to Garfield Road at end of easterly cul-de-sac. The water line will upgrade an existing 4" water line to an 8" water line. Residents adjacent to this water line installation will receive new lateral connections to the 8" line.
- The two-story approximately 11,079 SF, chapel would be located south of the entrance at Garfield Road, south of the Ceremonial Cleansing Facility, and is designed for family-oriented gatherings to celebrate the life of the deceased. It will provide permanent offices to support making funeral and burial arrangements, including religious services ancillary to the CCF, with family attendance.

Theda Road is not an issue that the MMCC wants to be addressed in order for the CUP to move forward. We do need to revisit our Conditions of Approval for the project with Transportation and Planning, and our request is that there are no physical improvements for the roadway tied to the CUP. As you know, the cemetery site plan has planned for ROW for the future Theda Road, if needed. The ROW cuts through the cemetery property which is not ideal and also takes up approximately 5 acres that could be used to burial spots. So, if Theda is not a needed roadway the group would like to use this area in the future for burials. We understand that the entire nearby circulation would need to be assessed to make any opinions about Theda and a future GPA which is why they'd like to start the conversation or at least know what that process may entail in the future.

Thanks,

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How did we do today? Please let us know by answering this short Survey!

From: Ramirez, Emilio <EmRamirez@Rivco.org>
Sent: Monday, May 12, 2025 3:41 PM
To: Selena Kelaher <selena@epdsolutions.com>
Subject: Muslim Mortuary and Cemetery

[NON-EPD]
Selena

I spoke with TLMA director and planner.

They are looking to place the CUP on the Planning Commission agenda in early July. They have indicated that the MND is currently under review with County Counsel, which will be complete soon. After noticing and circulating the document for a 30-day comment period then PC will be ready to hear the CUP.

They asked about the community benefits. I don't remember this part of our conversation. Can you update me on what the outstanding issue is here? They referenced a bus shelter.

Regarding the Theda Road. The vacation of Theda is not part of your current submittal. They say:

> "Theda Road runs North and South at the perimeter of the project along the eastern boundary. The project is phased with the primary area located at the western boundary. The vacation of the road could allow the addition of burial sites in the future but does not impact the current project. As Rania mentioned this would be a discussion with Transportation and could be reviewed as a separate project. Since we have clearance on the current site plan and design to make any changes would add to the timeline for public hearing. If we add the removal of Theda Road this would change the scope of the entitlement. Currently, Theda Rd. is designated for street improvements to 100 ft. full-width right-of-way and is a secondary access point to the project."

When can we talk?

Thank you

Emilio Ramirez

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County of Riverside California